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WHAT DETERMINES THE RIGHT DEPOSIT AMOUNT?

A Deposit Refund Scheme (DRS) adds a **refundable deposit** to eligible products, which consumers can reclaim when they return the empty packaging through designated return channels.

But how is that deposit amount determined?



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MORE THAN
A PRICE TAG

A deposit amount does more than assign a refundable value to packaging.

- **Behavioural Driver:** It acts as a primary economic incentive to encourage the return of DRS-eligible empty packaging.
- **Market Realities:** It must fit the economic realities of the market in which the scheme operates.



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There is more than one consideration.

The deposit amount needs to be considered in the context of:

- **Consumer affordability:** How the amount relates to the price of the product.
- **Return behaviour:** Whether the amount provides a meaningful reason to return the packaging.
- **Scheme objectives:** What the deposit is intended to support within the wider return system.
- **Market context:** The products, packaging formats and conditions in which the scheme operates.



These considerations do not operate in isolation. They form part of a broader scheme-design decision.

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THE RIGHT AMOUNT IS ABOUT BALANCE.

Depending on the scheme's design, deposit amounts may vary by **container volume or material type**, rather than remaining the same across all eligible packaging.

This allows deposit amounts to reflect differences in packaging size and material.



The aim is to set a deposit that encourages consumer returns, reflects packaging differences, and remains practical for the scheme to manage.

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